



Cotton nightwear and light bedding will help you stay cooler at night and get more restful and restorative sleep.

ASK A DOCTOR

I keep having really strange and vivid dreams. Is this normal during pregnancy? Yes, when you're pregnant, it's common to dream more and to remember your dreams. Experts attribute the vividness of these dreams to all the emotional and physical changes a pregnant woman is going through.

The vivid dreams may be a way for your unconscious to deal with all the hopes and fears you may have about your unborn baby and impending motherhood. It's common to dream that you give birth to an older baby, who is born walking and talking! This is thought to reflect a mother-to-be's insecurities about caring for a tiny, helpless baby. The older the baby, the more self-sufficient they appear. Having more dreams is also believed to be due to hormonal changes in pregnancy: increased levels of estrogen are thought to cause longer periods of REM (rapid eye movement) sleep—the phase of sleep in which we are most likely to dream.

If your dreams are disturbing, try writing them down to get them off your mind.